
The Hangman-Game

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1 | Revision History

Date	Version	Description	Author
2019-02-03	1.0	Starting up the planing of the project for exam 1	Fredrik Strömbäck

2 | General Information

Project Summary	
Project Name: The hangman-game	Project ID: fs222uv_1dv600_hangman
Project Manager: Fredrik Strömbäck	Main Client: Teachers of the course 1DV600
Key Stakeholders: Fredrik Strömbäck and the teachers of the course.	
Executive Summary: This is the project plan for the game that I am making for the course I am taking. This is made for the purpose of learning how to manage a bigger software project.	

3 | Vision

I will create a text-based hangman-game with JavaScript that the user/player could run in the nodejs-platform.

The game should start with a number of alternatives for the player to choose from. Here the player should be able to start the game, see the high-score list and exit the game, the choice is made by entering a number representing the different choices in the list presented.

When the user chooses to start the game, he/she will be asked to enter a player name, this will be saved in the high-score list if he/she can guess the word before the stick-figure is hanged.

After the user entered his/her name, a word from a list of words is chosen by random, this word is split up into individual letters but are displayed as underlines.

The user is now asked to enter a single letter, if the letter is present in the word chosen, every position with that letter should change from the underline to the letter entered. If the letter entered by the user is not in the word chosen, a part of the “hang-man” is displayed, for example the vertical pole. When the whole hangman is displayed, the user have lost the game and a new menu will appear and the user could start the game over.

What sets my game apart from other hangman games is that I would also want to add a local multiplayer mode, where another person could enter a word instead of that the word is chosen from the list of words. If the player completes the word they won't appear in the high-score list because that would not be fair. This is so that two people can play against each other on the same machine.

Reflection

I feel that it's very hard to think big with this project because the project itself is pretty small. Therefore the content of the vision document may be too specific. I can absolutely see the point of creating one though because this gives the person reading the document a good look of what the goals with the project are, without promising anything, and it is made clear for the client that may not understand the technology behind the project.

And the only one in the development team is me and I am already sure of what is being created, that makes this a little harder to write as well. I tried to let other people read it and all three of them (both other students and non students) understood what I wanted to create without me explaining it before they read this document.

4 | Project Plan

For the first iteration I will plan the project and write the vision document, try to plan for the following iterations, do the risk analysis and create a time log for each task in the iteration. I won't do any implementation of any code. I will however create some modules as skeleton-code, setup a package.json and install needed node modules, so when it's time to start implementing features I won't have to spend time doing that. I will also setup the application so it could be started with the "npm start"- command.

For now my plan is to create this game using or reusing modules/parts of a modules from other projects that I created. Each feature will get it's own module so the code in the modules could easily be maintained and changed.

Creating an object for each letter in the word chosen and push into an array to give the word the functionality needed, is my first thought for creating this game. The array of letters should then be displayed on the screen for the player.

How and if I will create the objects, if I use classes or other methods, and what functionality should be in what module will be decided in theme two where I will design the application using UML. So when it's time for iteration two my initial plan might change. So in every iteration I will have to update the project plan.

After that I will plan and do some testing, more details on this in iteration three.

4.1 Introduction

This is the assignment where I will create a text based hangman game for the course Software Tech (1DV600) I'm taking on Linnaeus University to become a web developer.

4.2 Justification

This application should be made for me to practice, so that I could use what I'm learning in this course when I'm being a part of or developing bigger projects/applications in the future. To be able to plan, design and test applications/systems is extremely important when developing bigger projects.

4.3 Stakeholders

Me and my teachers are the only stakeholder for this project, for me to pass this course I need this project to success, and of course my teachers have an interest of seeing that as many students as possible pass this course.

4.4 Resources

I a total of 9 weeks to complete this project. The course I am taking is at 50% speed so 20 hour a week.

Result: 180 hours to complete this project.

4.5 Hard- and Software Requirements

The application is developed on both Linux and Windows machines, the software is developed in Visual Studio Code and the application will run in nodejs.

I use the toggl web-app to track my time.

4.6 Overall Project Schedule

Deadlines:

Hand-in 1: 8 February

Hand-in 2: 21 February

Hand-in 3: 8 March

4.7 Scope, Constraints and Assumptions.

Scope:

In this project I will add a menu system for the hangman-game, a name entering feature, a feature to write and read a high-score list. And if there is time I would also like to add a simple multiplayer mode.

The application should also be able to print out a “hangman”-figure to show that the player are not guessing the correct letters.

The game should be able to start with the “npm-start”- command

There will not be any graphical interface because the game should be completely text based.

There will not be any part of the application where the player can see how a hangman game is played.

Constraints:

Time is a factor here, I only have a finite number of hours to do all this. I’m also new to developing for the nodejs-platform and that will absolutely set some limit of what I can do in the time available.

Assumptions:

I assume that the player knows how a simple game of hangman works.

Also that the user has some experience navigating in a text based environment (like a terminal) with only options presented to him/her.

Reflection

So far I think the project plan was the hardest part to write, because I am not completely sure of what to come in the following themes because this is the first time for me doing all of this. I can only plan for the first iteration right now and it’s pretty much just writing down everything I know so far about the project, analyze and reflect.

But as I said in the reflection of the vision document, I see the point of doing this too (especially when working with bigger projects and in bigger teams) but when I understand what designing with UML is and how testing actually works. But even then it would be hard to plan everything in detail before you are there, but at least then I could do better estimations of what would be included in each part, based on earlier experiences.

5 | Iterations

5.1 Iteration 1

Due date for iteration 1: 8th Feb 2019

The first iteration should be planed in detail.

I need to do everything in this iteration to pass this assignment.

Everything else is an addition.

The first iteration is the planing and setting up everything for the coming iterations. The iteration is split up into smaller tasks (see table down below), for easily managing.

Task	Responsible	Estimated Time
Set up git repo.	F.S	30 min
Create a skeleton document.	F.S	30 min
Write Vision Document.	F.S	1 hour
Write Project Plan.	F.S	1 hour
Plan iteration 2-4.	F.S	30 min
Risk Analysis.	F.S	2 hours
Writing skeleton-code and setup test modules.	F.S	1 hours
Fix start scripts in package.json	F.S	15 min

5.2 Iteration 2

Due date for iteration 1: 21th Feb 2019

Task	Responsible	Estimated Time
Design each feature with UML	F.S	
Implement features	F.S	

5.3 Iteration 3

Due date for iteration 1: 8th Mar 2019

Task	Responsible	Estimated Time
Plan tests	F.S	
Perform tests	F.S	
Document tests	F.S	
Implement new feature	F.S	

5.4 Iteration 4

Due date for iteration 1: 21th Mar 2019 (?)

Task	Responsible	Estimated Time
Complete the game	F.S	
Add extra features	F.S	

6 | Risk Analysis

6.1 List of risks

Risk	Probability	Impact
Computer/disk failure.	Low	Tolerable
The required time is underestimated.	High	Serious
Lack of skills to complete the project.	Moderate	Tolerable
Illness just before deadlines.	Moderate	Serious
The modules/code I plan to reuse doesn't work.	High	Insignificant

6.2 Strategies

Risk	Strategy
Computer/disk failure.	Always backup all the files both on Github and locally on other machines.
The required time is underestimated.	Plan each task with some slack.
Lack of skills to complete the project.	Ask for help from other students and/or teachers, when I get stuck and can't find solutions on my own.
Illness just before deadlines.	Try to complete each iteration in good time so if I get ill I still have time to finish the iteration in time for the deadline.
The modules/code I plan to use doesn't work.	"Repair" the modules or build new modules from scratch.

Reflection

This was absolutely the easiest part for me, I feel that I have more experience here, from earlier projects, what some risks are and I know how to minimize the impact if/when they occur. Here I feel that the size of the project limits the risks, for the good and the bad (good because not much could affect the project/product and I got no business to be affected. Bad because that I won't get as much practice to analyze and strategize). I think that I have to add more risks later when gain more understanding for the following themes, and the risk will be more specific to this project with that information.

7 | Time Log

Task	Responsible	Est. Time	Actual Time (15 min is minimum unit)
Set up git repo	F.S	30min	15 min*
Create skeleton document	F.S	30min	1 hour*
Write Vision document	F.S	1 hour	2 hours
Write Project Plan	F.S	1 hour 30 min	2 hours 30 min
Plan iteration 2-4	F.S	30 min	30 min
Risk Analysis	F.S	2 hours	1 hour 30 min
Writing skeleton-code and setup test modules.	F.S	1 hours	45 min
Fix start scripts in package.json	F.S	15 min	15 min

* = Estimation of the actual time. Forgot to time the task from the start.

And the time estimates are smaller than they should be because I realized too late that we should include the time for us learning/reading up on how to write a project plan.

The reason almost every task took longer than I estimated was because I clearly underestimated the time I needed to complete the task. I had to research while I was writing the tasks that I found hard to complete.

There are parts where the time was overestimated too, these were the tasks where I had experience from before, for example I've used Github in every course.